Some colonels are being sent to the United States for further professional training. Also, in 2015, Commander-in-Chief Senior General Min Aung Hlaing held regional seminars on defence and frequently took military friendship tours to Japan, Indonesia, Thailand, Malaysia, India, Israel, Russia, and China, to improve professionalism with the support of partners inside and outside the region.[7]

Throughout 2015, the military insisted it would be on guard to ensure that the election would be fair. Commander-in-Chief Senior General Min Aung Hlaing said that "any armed pressure or threats to voters couldn't be allowed in the General Elections" (Global New Light of Myanmar 2015), although he did not elaborate. At the time of the election, he took a leaf out of the president's book by being more open and engaging in dealing with the public and media on the military's role, especially in addressing questions about the transfer of power to the newly elected parties. After casting his vote, the commander responded to questions raised by the media. He said that there was no reason not to accept the election results. In a November 23 interview with the *Washington Post* posted to the senior general's Facebook page, he showed positive signs that power would be transferred peacefully. At a meeting with political parties in Yangon on 15 November 2015, the president, himself a former army general, also stressed that the current government would work for a smooth transition in line with existing laws, regulations, and procedures, and would do so calmly, peacefully, and smoothly so as not to cause concerns about the power transfer.

The questions are not surprising, given that in 1990 the election was held freely but it did not result in a power transfer. The reason given by the military to refuse to transfer power at that time was lack of a constitution. People still mistrust the government and Tatmadaw when it comes to the transfer of power, meetings with the NLD leader Daw Aung San Suu Kyi notwithstanding. The events of 1990 caused massive trauma for the political development of Myanmar, and fears of a U-turn or military coup will take time and many more confidence-building measures to dissipate.